

Reading Notes 3rd, Week 4

Basic Information

- Date: 2025/03/20
 - Link: [Pakistan Jails Baloch Human Rights Activist | TIME](#)
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Source Text and Paragraph Analysis

Pakistan Jails Baloch Human Rights Activist

1. Pakistan has again arrested Mahrang Baloch, a prominent champion of human rights for the country's ethnic Baloch minority, and barred her lawyer from visiting her in **jail**. ***(Introduce the main character and her significance)***
2. "She was looking weak and stressed," her sister Nadia Baloch told TIME on Monday after being allowed a few minutes with the activist in Quetta's Hudda District Prison, where she has been held since Saturday. Mahrang Baloch's lawyer was not allowed in; nor was the food her family had brought. "Our greatest fear is that she will be given contaminated food—or worse, something harmful," Nadia Baloch said. ***(Show Nadia worries about the living of her sister Mahrang who is stuck in the jail and the tough living condition of Mahrang in the jail)***
3. The circumstances of Mahrang Baloch's arrest illustrate both the complexities and the risks of her work for the Balochis. The ethnic group, whose population is often put at between 10 and 15 million, resides on arid lands divided by the borders of Pakistan, Iran, and Afghanistan. Like the Kurds, whose historic homeland was **arrayed** among several Middle Eastern states when nation states were being drawn, many Balochis want more autonomy, if not a state of their own—and some have **taken up arms**. Pakistan's Balochistan province has seen decades of conflict between the separatist Baloch Liberation Army (BLA) and a heavily militarized state. The latest clash, on March 11, appeared to mark a dramatic new level in its **guerrilla** and terror operations when a BLA force hijacked a train, resulting in scores of deaths. ***(Stating the successive conflicts among different groups of Baloch in Pakistan)***
4. Pakistan's response to the **insurgency** has been a decades-long "dirty war" that has left thousands of Balochi citizens missing and **presumed** dead. Mahrang Baloch founded the Baloch Yekjehti Solidarity Committee to advocate for a political future grounded in recognition of human rights, including **ascertaining** the fates of the disappeared. The state

has not engaged, however. ***(The main character advocated for the unity and human rights among Baloch but the government is passive to the situation)***

5. After the **hijacking** of the Jaffar Express, state security forces **ramped up** pressure on Balochi human rights advocates, **detaining** several **Solidarity** activists in Quetta, the Balochistan provincial capital. On Friday, state forces opened fire on protesters who had assembled to demand their release, killing three. Mahrang Baloch was arrested the next day at a sit-in where protesters had assembled with the bodies of the victims. ***(State the government of the state ramped up pressure on the advocates)***
6. “She is quite strong. She will not give up on this,” said Imran Baloch, her **attorney**, who like many Balochis uses Baloch as a surname but is no relation. The lawyer said the state clearly feels threatened by Mahrang’s increasing prominence, noting that it **escalated** against her in October after she was included in the TIME100 Next list of the world’s **emerging** leaders. Mahrang learned that she had been placed on a no-fly list and her passport had been suspended only when she was turned away from her flight to New York to attend a TIME event. Her lawyer said she also felt “pressurized” by the state after she was nominated for the 2025 Nobel Peace Prize. ***(Introduce the prominence and reputation of the main character and his pressure about that from the authority)***
7. “There is a complex web of violence and human-rights **violations** in Balochistan that creates a very challenging environment for human-rights defenders, particularly women human-rights defenders, working on issues of enforced disappearance,” Sarah de Roure, the global head of protection at the advocacy group Front Line Defenders, told TIME in October, after Mahrang was detained at the Karachi airport. ***(Cite the words of the professor to express the complexity and challenges of the human-rights defenders)***
8. “She is being targeted as a woman, she is being targeted as a Baloch woman, because of the work that she’s doing, which is publicly speaking on the issue of enforced disappearance—initially around her own family, and then as part of a broader movement.” ***(The professor express the respect to the main character)***
9. Following her latest arrest, prominent human rights advocates, including Nobel **laureate** Malala Yousafzai and the U.N. Special Rapporteur for Human Rights Defenders, called for her release. ***(Many distinguished people called for the release of the main character)***
10. Nadia Baloch, the sister, said family members were turned away the three previous days they went to the jail. “So today we said that we will be on hunger strike if you will not allow us to meet her. Then they just allowed me to visit her for few minutes,” she said. “She did not know the reason that she was arrested. I must say that is illegal, that they have not allowed her lawyer to meet her. They have isolated her in a room separate from the other prisoners.” ***(Show Mahrang's family's opposition of the illegal arrest for her)***

Significant Words and Phrases

- jail #CET4 #CET6 :
prison or make somebody in prison
- array #CET6 :
set; an orderly arrangement
- take up arms:
go for war and fight
- guerrilla:
a member of irregular armed force that fight by moving strategy
- insurgency:
a group of members fight against the constituted authority
- presume #CET6 :
take to be the case or to be true, assume
- ascertain #CET6 :
to find out or determine something
- hijack #CET4 #CET6 :
take something by force
- ramp up #CET4 #CET6 :
increase gradually
- detain #CET6 :
deprive of freedom and arrest somebody
- solidarity #CET6 :
unity
- attorney #CET4 #CET6 :
the lawyer or the agent
- escalate #CET6 :
increase the intent.
- emerging #CET4 #CET6 :
coming into view
- violation #CET4 #CET6 :
a act that are against the agreement or laws

Topic Idea

This article introduced the authority of Pakistan jailed Mahrang Baloch, a human rights activist and through the complicated situation in her region to show her reputation and prominence and to call for human rights for Baloch in Pakistan.

Structure

In the beginning, the article introduces the main character and her contribution. Then it shows the complicated situation in Pakistan, her endeavor for human rights in her region and her fame abroad and at home. At last show her family's opposition to the illegal arrest.

Structure Of Reading Notes 3rd

